OTT TITANS · RIDDLE VAULT

THE SUM EVERYONE GETS WRONG

1000 + 40 + 1000 + 30 + ...

THE CASE IN ONE LINE
Eight additions a child could do — and a room full of adults announcing the wrong total.

CASE 08 · ONE RIDDLE · ONE ANSWER · NO SHORTCUTS

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THE CASE

No paper. No calculator. Just count in your head, the way the voice in the video counts:

Take 1,000. Add 40. Add another 1,000. Add 30. Add another 1,000. Add 20. Add another 1,000. Add 10.

Say your total out loud before you read another line of this book. If you said the number most people say, you have just met one of the most reliable traps in all of mental arithmetic.

THE QUESTION

What is 1000 + 40 + 1000 + 30 + 1000 + 20 + 1000 + 10?

THREE HINTS

Open them one at a time. Stop the moment you have it — the last hint nearly gives it away.

HINT 1
Slow down and say every running total out loud. The trap lives in the skipping.

HINT 2
The four small numbers are not thousands in disguise. Added together, they make only 100.

HINT 3
Watch the rhythm: thousand, thousand, thousand. Your brain starts hearing a pattern — and patterns are where errors hide.

YOUR MOVE

What is 1000 + 40 + 1000 + 30 + 1000 + 20 + 1000 + 10?

Decide your answer now — say it out loud or write it in the comments — before you turn this page. No going back.

THE REVEAL

THE ANSWER

4,100 — not 5,000, which is what most people announce.

Step by step, out loud: 1000 + 40 = 1040. + 1000 = 2040. + 30 = 2070. + 1000 = 3070. + 20 = 3090. + 1000 = 4090. + 10 = 4100.

Four thousands make 4000. The small additions — 40 + 30 + 20 + 10 — make exactly 100. Total: 4,100.

WHY IT WORKS

The sequence leans on rhythm. After several clean thousands, the brain starts treating every step as another thousand and rounds the small additions away — the running total 'feels' like it clicks up in thousands.

The total of the small numbers being a round 100 is the designer's final cruelty: the true answer ends in 100, the trap answer in 000, and both feel equally tidy. Only the spoken running totals protect you.

THE TRAP, NAMED

Pattern hunger. The brain would rather complete a rhythm than carry a number — so it quietly promotes 40, 30, 20 and 10 into thousands.

MAKE THE VIDEO

This book is a production pack. The route from page to posted video:

1 · OPEN THE BOOK
The story, the question and the reveal in this book are your script beats, in order.

2 · GIVE IT TO THE AGENT
Paste the case into your AI agent (run it on Google Antigravity) and let it plan the shots from the beats.

3 · CONNECT GOOGLE FLOW
The agent builds the scenes as short clips in Flow. Keep the question on screen until the final seconds — the reveal is the last beat, never the first.

4 · EDIT + POST
Post with the question as the caption's first line and pin a comment asking for answers BEFORE the reveal. The debate in the comments is the engine.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

RIDDLE VAULT is the OTT Titans series of one-riddle books: one case per book, a verified answer, and the production route to turn it into a video. Every answer in this series is solved and checked before the book is made — if the logic has a hole, the riddle does not ship.

OWNERSHIP
This book — its text, structure and design — is owned by OTT TITANS. Reading or downloading it grants you the right to enjoy it and to produce your own version of the riddle video on your own channels. It never transfers ownership of the book.

More cases are waiting in the Vault — and a new riddle video lands every day on the 1 Minute Detective channels.

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